# The First Chatbot KEY

Name _____

Work with a partner. Compare answers when you finish each problem.

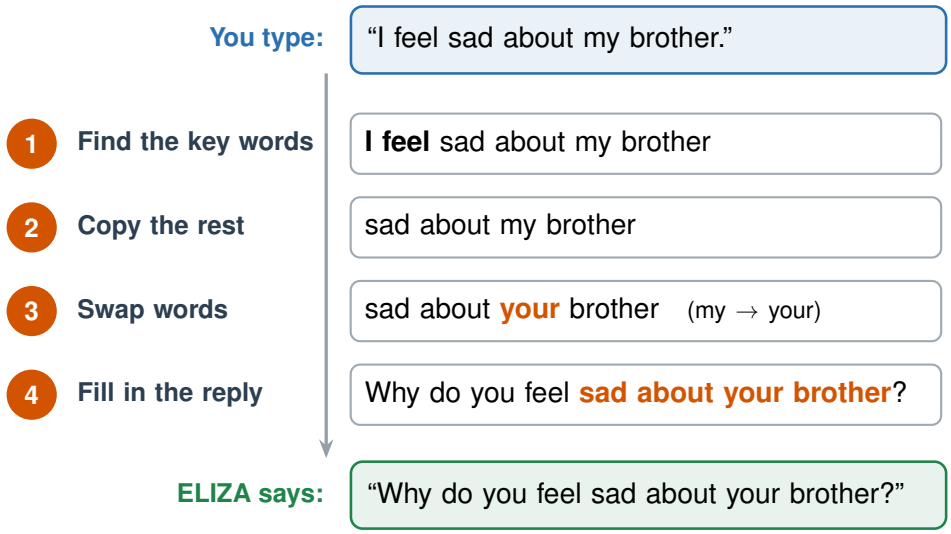
**1. Be ELIZA.** One partner is ELIZA. ELIZA can only answer with this card.

| **If your partner says . . .** | **ELIZA says . . .** |
|---|---|
| I feel _____ | Why do you feel _____? |
| I am _____ | How long have you been _____? |
| I want _____ | Why do you want _____? |
| a word about family | Tell me more about your family. |
| anything else | Please go on. |

Write one thing ELIZA said that sounded **caring**: Answers vary.

Write one thing ELIZA said that sounded **strange**: Answers vary.

**2. How ELIZA works.**




Now you are ELIZA. Your partner types: **"I am worried about my test."**

1. Find the key words: I am

2. Copy the rest: worried about my test

3. Swap words: worried about your test (my → your)

4. Fill in the reply: How long have you been worried about your test?

### 3. People believed it.

When people feel that a computer understands them, but it does not, we call it the ELIZA effect.

### 4. The Klingon Room. Work in a group of 2 to 4.

Did the person in the room understand Klingon? no

How do you know? They only matched shapes in the rule book.

One note asked: “Do you speak Klingon?” The room said: Yes. I am learning Klingon.

Was that true? no Did the replies make sense to the people outside? yes

### 5. Talk about it.

The whole room **does** / **does not** understand Klingon, because Answers vary.

ELIZA is like the Klingon Room because both follow rules and do not know what the words mean.

**Go Further (Day 2).** Change ELIZA’s rules.

A sentence that **broke** ELIZA: Answers vary.

What ELIZA said: Answers vary. Example: Please go on.

**My new rule.** When someone says: i like * ELIZA says: Why do you like *?

Did your rule work? **ELL** My rule in my home language: Answers vary.

✂ *Cut out the cards. Add them to the class timeline.*

**1966**

Joseph Weizenbaum makes **ELIZA**, one of the first chatbots. It follows rules. People believe it understands them.

Draw a picture here.

**1980**

John Searle asks: if a room answers by following rules, does it **understand**? (The Chinese Room)

Draw a picture here.